

ART AND CREATIVE EDUCATION - I

Comprehensive Study Notes on Visual Expression, Sketching & Clay Craft, Sattriya Cultural Heritage, John Berger's Ways of Seeing, Elements of Composition, Masters & Monuments, and BALA Classroom Integration

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Curriculum Session 2026

SYLLABUS BLUEPRINT & MARKS ALLOCATION

3 Core Units • Total: 20 External + 30 Internal Marks

Unit 1

Development of Skill

Creative Writing, Sketching, Stenciling, Clay

10 Marks

Unit 2

History & Theory of Art

Sattriya Heritage, Ways of Seeing, Elements

5 Marks

Unit 3

Documentation & Monuments

Indian/Western Masters, Da-Parbatia, Madan Kamdev

5 Marks

Practicum

Workshops, BALA & SIP-I

Posters, Albums, Wall Murals, Field Studies

30 Marks

UNIT 1: DEVELOPMENT OF EXPRESSIVE & CREATIVE SKILLS

Creative Writing, Observational Outdoor Sketching, Stenciling, Indigenous Toy Craft & Tactile Clay Modeling

WEIGHTAGE: 10 MARKS

1.1 CREATIVE WRITING: MEMORY, METAPHOR, DRAMATIC SCRIPT & CLASSROOM JOURNALISM

Literary & Cathartic Art

Art education is not restricted to paint on canvas; **literary and performative creation** is an integral aesthetic discipline. In elementary education, creative writing provides emotional catharsis, unlocks subconscious imagery, and develops narrative empathy. When children articulate their inner world through words, language ceases to be a dry textbook subject and transforms into living self-expression:

1. Childhood Memory Essays

Harvesting personal sensory recollections (the smell of wet Assam soil after rain, fear of dark bamboo groves, village fairs). Teaches vivid adjective use and emotional honesty.

2. Story & Poetry Crafting

Composing rhythmic nursery rhymes, nonsense verses, and folktale adaptations. Children explore alliteration, onomatopoeia, and plot structures (conflict, climax, moral resolution).

3. Role-Play Scriptwriting

Drafting conversational scripts for puppet shows, environmental street plays, and historical skits. Cultivates dialogue pacing, vocal inflection, and character perspective-taking.

4. Classroom News Journalism

Writing daily class reports on the weather, bird sightings in the schoolyard, or cultural celebrations. Connects objective observation with lively reportage for school wall magazines.

1.2 OUTDOOR SKETCHING, DRAWING FROM NATURE & STILL LIFE OBSERVATION

Perceptual Acuity

Drawing is not merely a motor skill; it is a way of *thinking with the eye and hand*. Traditional rote instruction forces children to copy rigid textbook diagrams from the blackboard. Genuine art education takes learners outdoors to observe nature directly:

Outdoor Studies & Drawing from Nature:

- **Observing Botanical Details:** Sketching leaf venation, tree bark textures, seed pods, and the branching angles of local bamboo clumps.
- **Capturing Natural Light & Horizon:** Understanding how daylight shifts shadows across school ponds, paddy fields, and morning mist.
- **Developing Visual Memory:** Children observe an insect or flying kingfisher for 60 seconds, then draw its silhouette from mental memory.

Still Life Drawing & Spatial Depth:

- **Arranging Everyday Objects:** Composing traditional brass utensils (*Kahi, Bati*), earthen pots, water jugs, and ripe fruits on a wooden table.
- **Positive vs. Negative Space:** Training the eye to see the background air spaces between objects, not just the objects themselves.
- **Cross-Hatching & Shading:** Using pencil pressure and cross-strokes to create illusions of 3D volume, cast shadows, and reflective highlights.

1.3 & 1.4 STENCIL CRAFT, INDIGENOUS TOY MAKING, COLLAGE & TACTILE CLAY MODELING

Hands-On Tactile Intelligence

1. Stencil Printing

Cutting cardboard or leaf templates to explore positive/negative silhouettes and repeat geometric patterns for book covers and textile borders.

2. Indigenous Toy Making

Crafting moving toys from local bamboo splints, jute twine, dried gourd shells, and discarded cardboard. Implements NEP 2020 Toy Pedagogy!

3. Collage Composition

Tearing and pasting discarded newspapers, dry tea leaves, fabric remnants, and colored wrappers to build textured visual landscapes without expensive paints.

4. Clay Modeling (মৃৎশিল্প)

Kneading river clay to shape animals, fruits, and miniature pots. Strengthens fine-motor pincer dexterity and translates 2D mental ideas into solid 3D form.

Teacher's Recipe for Safe Classroom Play-Dough: In rural schools without clay, mix 2 cups wheat flour (*Aata*), $\frac{1}{2}$ cup salt, 2 tablespoons vegetable oil, and warm water. Tint with natural turmeric (*Haladi* for yellow), spinach extract (green), or beetroot juice (red). 100% non-toxic, sensory-rich, and zero-cost!

UNIT 2: HISTORY AND THEORY OF ART & THE CULTURAL HERITAGE OF ASSAM

Sattriya Traditions, Borgeet, Bhaona, Sachipat Paintings, Ways of Seeing & Elements of Visual Art

WEIGHTAGE: 5 MARKS

2.1 & 2.2 SATTRIYA CULTURE: THE NEO-VAISHNAVITE ARTISTIC RENAISSANCE OF ASSAM

Mahapurush Srimanta Sankardeva (1449–1568)

In the 15th and 16th centuries, **Mahapurush Srimanta Sankardeva** and his prime disciple **Sri Sri Madhabdeva** spearheaded an extraordinary cultural and egalitarian renaissance in Assam. Rather than confining spiritual expression to dry scripture, Sankardeva harnessed the visual, performing, and musical arts to unite a multi-ethnic society. The Sattri institutions became epicenters of five interrelated artistic pillars:

1. Borgeet (বৰগীত)

Noble, classical devotional songs composed in the sacred literary language *Brjavali*, set to rigorous classical Ragas and spiritual Talas on the *Khol* drum.

2. Sattriya Nritya (সত্ৰীয়া নৃত্য)

Recognized by Sangeet Natak Akademi as one of India's 8 classical dance forms. Defined by exquisite hand gestures (*Mudras*), footwork, and devotion (*Bhakti*).

3. Bhaona & Ankiya Naat

Traditional theatre staged in community *Namghars*. Features dramatic masks (*Mukha* craft of Majuli), elaborate costumes, dance-dialogues, and moral upliftment.

4. Sachipat Manuscript Art

Painting on bark from the Sachi tree (*Aquilaria gallocha*). Masterpieces like *Chitra Bhagavata* and *Hastividhyarnava* using natural mineral and botanical dyes.

2.3 JOHN BERGER'S "WAYS OF SEEING" (দৰ্শনৰ খাৰণা)

Art critic John Berger established that "*Seeing comes before words. The child looks and recognizes before it can speak.*" How we look at art is never neutral; it is conditioned by social habits, media exposure, and historical context:

- **The Gaze is Selective:** We only look at what we are trained or conditioned to notice.
- **Reproducibility of Imagery:** Digital photography and smartphones duplicate art endlessly, often stripping original paintings of their sacred aura and contemplative stillness.
- **Pedagogical Duty:** Teach children to look critically at advertising billboards, magazine photos, and social media imagery to identify hidden consumerist manipulation!

Visual literacy is as essential for 21st-century citizenship as reading text!

2.4 VISUAL ARTS VS. FINE ARTS

- **Visual Arts:** The broad umbrella term encompassing everything created primarily for visual perception—painting, sculpture, printmaking, photography, video, design, crafts, and architecture.
- **Fine Arts:** Historically cultivated purely for aesthetic contemplation, intellectual beauty, and spiritual expression (painting, sculpture, classical music) rather than practical utility.

- **Applied / Decorative Arts:** Visual arts applied to functional objects of daily utility (weaving Assamese *Gamosa*, pottery, bamboo furniture, bell-metal casting).

In primary school, merge Fine Arts with Applied Folk Crafts!

2.5 THE SEVEN BUILDING BLOCKS: ELEMENTS OF VISUAL ART & COMPOSITION

7 Core Elements

1. Line

Straight, curved, jagged, diagonal; creates movement, contour, and energy.

2. Shape

2D enclosed area; geometric (circles, squares) vs. organic (leaves, puddles).

3. Form

3D entity with height, width, and depth (cubes, spheres, sculpted clay animals).

4. Colour

Hue, value (light/dark), saturation; primary (R/Y/B) and complementary pairs.

5. Value

Gradation from pure white to deep black; renders volume through light and shadow.

6. Texture

Surface tactile feel: rough bark, smooth pebble, prickly pineapple, soft silk.

7. Space

Perspective, foreground, middle ground, background, and breathing room.

Principles of Design / Composition: How the elements are organized—*Balance* (symmetrical vs asymmetrical), *Rhythm / Movement*, *Contrast*, *Focal Point / Emphasis*, and *Unity / Harmony*.

2.6 AIMS & EDUCATIONAL VALUES OF FINE ARTS (ELLIOT EISNER)

- **Cultivating Multiple Solutions:** Unlike multiple-choice math tests with only one answer, art teaches children that problems can have countless valid, beautiful solutions.
- **Nuanced Perception:** Developing sensitivity to subtle differences in tone, mood, line curvature, and emotional resonance.
- **Cognitive Flexibility:** Engaging with non-verbal metaphors, building patience, emotional regulation, and joyful concentration.

2.7 AESTHETICS, INDIGENOUS CULTURE & LIVELIHOOD IN ASSAM

Art in Assam is not a luxury hobby for elite salons; it is woven directly into rural economic sustenance and ethnic dignity:

- **Sericulture & Weaving:** Traditional handloom weaving of *Muga, Eri*, and *Pat* silk by rural women weavers generating household income in Rupees (₹).
- **Bamboo & Cane Crafts:** Crafting the iconic *Japi* headgear, fishing traps (*Polo, Jaki*), and domestic baskets.
- **Bell Metal of Sarthebari:** Hand-hammered bell-metal ware (*Kahi, Bati, Sarai*).
- **Terracotta of Asharikandi (Dhubri):** Red clay pottery and decorative village figurines.

UNIT 3: DOCUMENTATION OF ART, LEGENDARY MASTERS & ARCHITECTURAL MONUMENTS

Contemporary Indian and Western Masters, Ajanta, Ellora, Khajuraho, Madan Kamdev & Da-Parbatia

WEIGHTAGE: 5 MARKS

3.1 PIONEERS OF VISUAL ART: INDIAN & WESTERN MASTERS

Art Historical Canon

IN Master Indian Trailblazers

- **Raja Ravi Varma (1848–1906):** Fused European academic realism and oil techniques with Hindu epics (Mahabharata, Ramayana), democratizing divine imagery via oleograph litho-presses.
- **Abanindranath Tagore (1871–1951):** Founder of the Bengal School of Art; rejected European materialism in favor of Swadeshi spiritual wash paintings (iconic *Bharat Mata*).
- **Jamini Roy & Nandalal Bose:** Roy embraced raw Santhal and Kalighat folk simplicity; Bose led Santiniketan art and illuminated the original Constitution of India manuscript!
- **Sobha Brahma (1929–2012):** Assam's monumental modernist painter and sculptor; pioneer of contemporary Assamese fine arts blending tribal folk motifs with modernism.

Master Western Trailblazers

- **Leonardo da Vinci (1452–1519):** Supreme Italian Renaissance polymath; master of *Sfumato* (delicate smoky gradations), anatomical accuracy, and perspective (*Mona Lisa, The Last Supper*).
- **Vincent van Gogh (1853–1890):** Post-Impressionist titan whose turbulent impasto brushwork, swirling lines, and raw colors expressed deep psychic emotion (*The Starry Night, Sunflowers*).
- **Pablo Picasso (1881–1973):** Co-founder of Cubism; shattered traditional single-point Renaissance perspective to depict subjects simultaneously from multiple angles (*Guernica*).

3.2 MONUMENTAL ARCHITECTURAL SITES OF INDIA & ASSAM

5 Heritage Anchors

1. Ajanta Caves (Maharashtra)

30 rock-cut Buddhist cave monuments (2nd c. BCE – 5th c. CE). Globally renowned for ancient fresco-secco mural paintings depicting Jataka tales, spiritual compassion, and supple bodily movement (*Padmapani Bodhisattva*).

2. Ellora Caves (Maharashtra)

34 rock-cut shrines spanning Hindu, Buddhist, and Jain traditions. Home to Cave 16: the breathtaking monolithic **Kallash Temple**, carved entirely top-down from a single basalt mountain cliff!

3. Khajuraho (Madhya Pradesh)

Chandela dynasty temples (950–1050 CE) representing the pinnacle of Nagara sandstone temple architecture. Celebrated for intricate exterior carvings depicting celestial maidens (*Apsaras*), music, war, and spiritual union.

4. Madan Kamdev (Baihata Chariali, Assam)

Celebrated as the "Khajuraho of Assam", 10th–12th century archaeological ruins of the Kamarupa Pala dynasty perched atop Madanguri hill. Features ornate granite reliefs, dancing Ganeshas, lion gargoyles, and erotic sculpture.

5. Da-Parbatia Temple Doorframe (Tezpur, Assam)

The oldest and most exquisite sculptural relic of classical Gupta art in Assam (5th–6th century CE). The ancient sandstone doorframe features breathtaking, graceful carvings of river goddesses **Ganga** and **Yamuna** standing upon divine lotuses, flanked by flying swans (*Hamsas*) and celestial garlands. A crown jewel of Indian architectural heritage!

★ PAPER S1.7 PRACTICUM, WORKSHOP & INTERNAL ASSESSMENT ARCHITECTURE (30 MARKS)

Syllabus 2026

Workshops & Painting
10 Marks
Performance in Practical Arts

Assignments Submission
5 Marks
Albums / Monument Project

Institutional Unit Test
5 Marks
Internal Written Evaluation

SIP-I School Art Activity
10 Marks
BALA / Wall Magazine / Dance

Prescribed Practicum Tasks (Institutional Workshops):

- **Outdoor Nature Studies:** Outdoor landscape observation, recording natural light, and analyzing color compositions in sketchbook albums.
- **Monument Album Project:** Compiling an illustrated monograph documenting Assam's architectural heritage (e.g., Da-Parbatia, Madan Kamdev, Rang Char, Talatal Ghar, Shiva Douli).
- **Creative Craft Workshop:** Designing stencils, hand-turned painted clay pots, waste material collage compositions, and indigenous bamboo toys.
- **Innovative Art Centre Design:** Planning an engaging, low-cost "Art and Activity Corner" inside a local primary school.

School Internship (SIP-I Linkage - 10 Marks):

During the 2-week School Internship-I, student-teachers will select and execute at least two art activities with elementary children: (1) **BALA (Building as Learning Aid)**: Creating instructional educational paintings and geometric murals directly on primary classroom walls; (2) **Community Awareness Posters**: Leading children to design posters against social evils (child marriage, child labour, plastic pollution); (3) **Wall Magazine Creation**: Compiling children's spontaneous drawings, folk poems, and hand-traced emojis into a vibrant school wall magazine; (4) **Traditional Dance & Music**: Transacting regional folk rhymes, Borgeet, or traditional Bihu rhythms.